

AN AUTOBIOGRAPHICAL ANIMATED THRILLER

CHARACTER BIBLE

Fiango core cast and protected future-cast guide

Character system

Every visual difference must reveal how a person acts under pressure. These images are character-development composites, not literal portraits.

ZINO

Quick movement, bright attention, earth and faded blue; turns loss into a story.

GRAND

Stillness, clean navy and gold; the imagined answer to every impossible problem.

GIDEON

Camera and crossed-body bag; scans for a route to money before he speaks.

LUC

Small Bible, square posture and clean lines; moral courage without a sermon.

MOTHER

Teacher’s papers, practical shoes and upright control; care expressed through action.

UNCLE

Lawyer-era suits, faith and bulk cocoa trade; family pride with unresolved limits.

MISS MUKETE

Glass, chalk and blue/white precision; academic attention with standards.

LANDLORD

Keys and ledger; money pressure present without turning him into a villain.

NON-NEGOTIABLE FACT BOUNDARIES

- Zino’s father is family testimony and must remain outside Zino’s firsthand point of view.
- Elianne’s timing and story are unconfirmed; she receives agency before romance.
- The unnamed aunt, U.S. girlfriend, crypto circle and boarding cast are protected placeholders until Zino supplies the detail needed to distinguish them truthfully.
- Physical traits below are proposed animation choices and must change when a real reference, correction or fictionalisation direction arrives.

Nkeh “Zino” Nkengzincho

The real boy at the centre of the story



CHARACTER

ZINO

Gifted footballer, storyteller and future-builder.

ON SCREEN

Confirmed foundation: ten in Chapter One’s opening; born 1990; bright, witty, kind and just. Pidgin with friends, English at home, French and English at school. He wants to build his mother a house.

DISTINCT SIGNALS

Slim, quick-footed silhouette; tapered curls, expressive brow and a fast smile; faded white vest, worn blue shorts, scuffed ball, coins and school bag.

CONTINUITY HOLD

Temper, people-pleasing and limited self-awareness must coexist with intelligence. Do not make hardship his only trait.

Grand-Chukuchuku

The man Zino invents when ordinary life needs an impossible answer



CHARACTER

GRAND-CHUKUCHUKU

Zino’s fictional adult ideal; never a literal future or supernatural force.

ON SCREEN

Confirmed foundation: Zino tells friends stories about this man doing what nobody else can. He appears only while Zino actively crosses reality with fiction.

DISTINCT SIGNALS

Locked baseline: tapered curls, close beard, warm brown complexion, navy suit, open white shirt and brown shoes. Navy, cream and gold mark imagination; a composed eye line and stillness set him apart.

CONTINUITY HOLD

He may not fly, fight, rescue real consequences or become a superhero. As the story grows darker, he can fail to appear.

The school orbit

Distinct friends who make Fiango feel lived in



CHARACTER

GIDEON

Business-minded friend and sideline banter; never a football player.

ON SCREEN

Confirmed: camera in secondary school, birthday gigs, often pays, quiet with girls. Loves Sophy in Forms Two–Five. Watches and banters when Zino plays.

DISTINCT SIGNALS

Camera bag and guarded posture. The updated school portrait uses sky-blue short sleeves and dark-blue trousers; casual clothes remain separate.

CHARACTER

LUC

Faithful, candid friend; the group’s conscience.

ON SCREEN

Confirmed: carries a small Bible, preaches, values Zino’s maths help. Does not play football; evangelises or chats nearby.

DISTINCT SIGNALS

Lean posture and small Bible. The corrected portrait follows the day-school uniform: sky-blue short sleeves and dark-blue trousers.

CHARACTER

ELIANNE

Previously named first love; identity/place still open.

ON SCREEN

Lizzy is now confirmed as the school girlfriend: crush Form One, together Form Two, breakup Form Three. Do not merge or delete Elianne without clarification.

DISTINCT SIGNALS

Old school-era look is provisional. Girls’ day-school uniform is sky-blue short sleeves with a dark-blue skirt.

CONTINUITY HOLD

See the appended character update for Lizzy, Mirabel, Sophy and Tracey; new portraits are not yet supplied.

The people behind the promise

Mother, uncle and an inherited absence



CHARACTER

ZINO’S MOTHER

Single mother, primary-school teacher and Zino’s most important promise.

ON SCREEN

Confirmed: taught from a young age throughout his childhood; believed in him and raised him after his father died.

DISTINCT SIGNALS

Wax-print teacher dresses, marked exercise books, practical shoes and controlled upright posture. Care shows in action, not pity.

CHARACTER

PATERNAL UNCLE

Renowned lawyer, Christian convert and cocoa businessman; supports school at times.

ON SCREEN

Known for suits. By Form Three, a large Kumba cocoa store ships trailers to Douala. O-Level pride leads to the America promise, later deferred until after a degree.

DISTINCT SIGNALS

The updated charcoal suit illustrates his lawyer era. Later store/dispatch dress is open. Cocoa links him to his brother’s farming livelihood.

CONTINUITY HOLD

Conversion/work overlap, support timing and deferral motive remain open; professional success does not prove household cash access.

CHARACTER

ZINO’S FATHER

A loss Zino inherited, not a memory he owns.

ON SCREEN

Limited formal schooling; grew and sold cocoa. Family testimony: fatal snake bite when Zino was two; Zino has no direct recollection.

DISTINCT SIGNALS

Use a respectful photo, told memory or restrained symbolic image only. The cocoa-farmer portrait is nonliteral.

CONTINUITY HOLD

No first-person Zino flashback, invented dialogue, injury spectacle or invented character history.

Adults who shape the frame

Academic attention and the ordinary pressure of money



CHARACTER

MISS MUKETE

Zino’s favourite chemistry teacher.

ON SCREEN

Confirmed: favourite chemistry teacher. No other biography or exact likeness is yet supplied.

DISTINCT SIGNALS

Proposed: gold-rimmed glasses, blue patterned blouse, lab coat, chemistry book and small glass beaker. Exact, observant and encouraging without becoming generic inspiration.

CONTINUITY HOLD

Do not build a personal episode around her until Zino provides a specific classroom memory.

CHARACTER

THE LANDLORD

The recurring face of the compound’s rent and electricity calculations.

ON SCREEN

Confirmed: comes monthly to collect rent and light money from a compound of families, single mothers, bachelors and student tenants.

DISTINCT SIGNALS

Proposed: lean older silhouette, silver at the temples, pale shirt, dark trousers, sandals, keys and ledger. His calm routine lets money pressure enter without claiming malice.

CONTINUITY HOLD

No invented debt amount, motive or confrontation presented as fact.

Known, but not visually locked

These people and groups belong in the series, but they need details before they receive a visual identity or speak for themselves.

MATERNAL AUNT

Confirmed: cooked for and supported Zino, believed in him, and was later attacked and killed. Needed: name, age, memories, date/place/context, visual reference and source boundary.

U.S. GIRLFRIEND

Confirmed: Zino identifies a girlfriend during the America years. Needed: name or fictionalisation choice, years together, her perspective, relationship change and consent boundaries.

BOARDING-SCHOOL CAST

Confirmed environment: elite students, wealthy parents, white teachers and priests, bullying, strict discipline. Needed: names, individual roles, actual incidents and visual references.

FOOTBALL FRIENDS / CRYPTO CIRCLE

Confirmed: Zino pitched Nkap and njangi.xyz to football friends. His account alleges later reporting to immigration and an attempted takeover. Needed: names or fictionalisation plan, records, contributions and a defensible account before anyone is depicted doing harm.

DUBAI COLLEAGUES

Confirmed: Zino moved to Dubai in 2020 and worked for a Chinese online retailer of digital products. Needed: work function, people, setting and perspectives.

UNIVERSITY / IMMIGRATION CHARACTERS

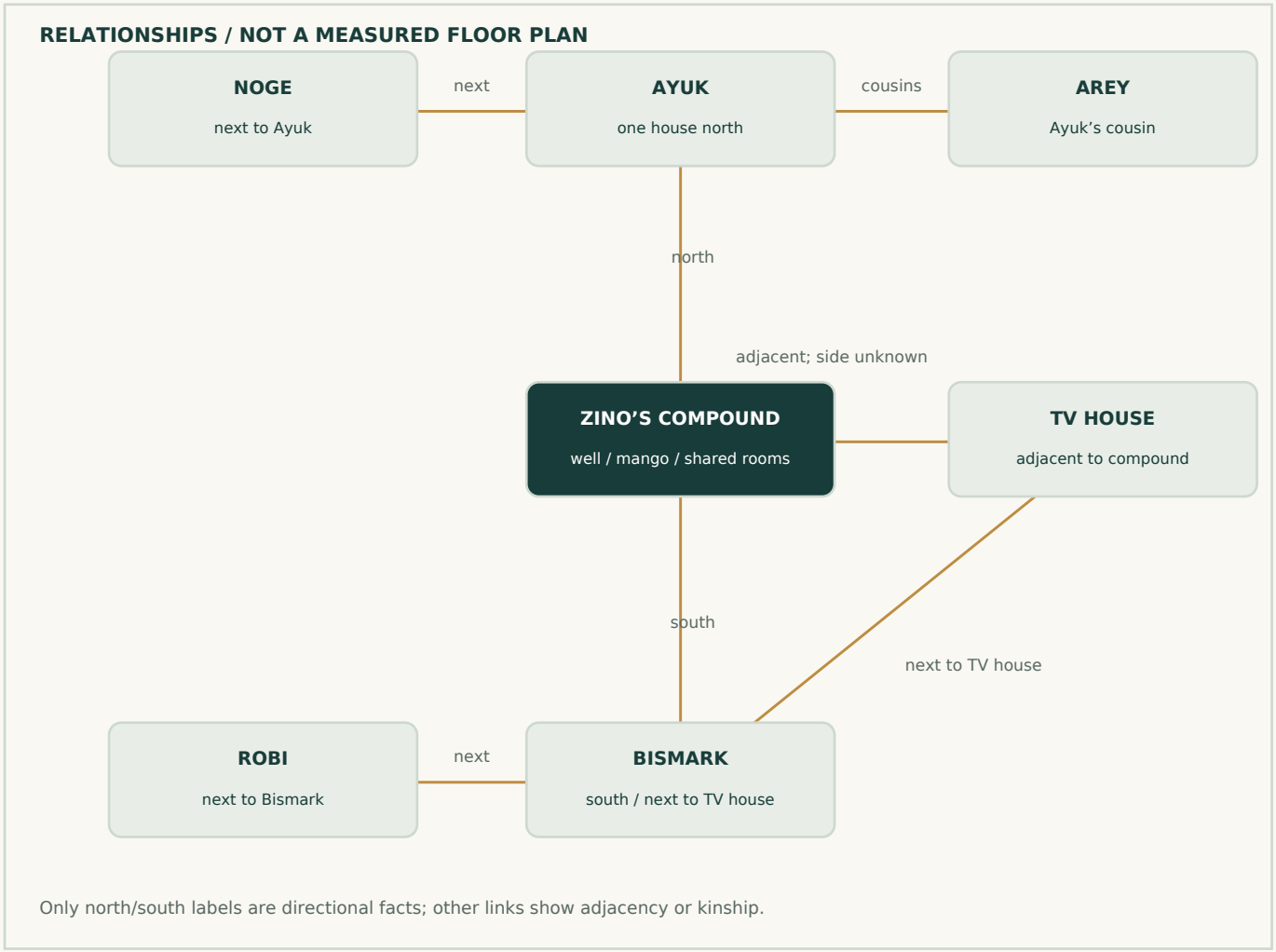
Confirmed: Oklahoma studies beginning 2012, money, papers, loneliness, racism and deportation in 2019. Needed: dates, documents, names, events and a fictionalisation plan.

PRODUCTION RULE

A visual design must follow character truth. Until the source is known, preserve the narrative space rather than filling it with a convincing invention.

Fiango: who lives where

An adjacency guide from Zino’s recollections. This diagram does not invent compass directions, addresses, room measurements or a home for Arey.



Room correction: Zino’s room is two apartments away from Mother’s front room. The tenants share two bathrooms. A separate detailed compound plan needs the doorway/room arrangement and ages confirmed.

Football correction: Ayuk, Arey, Noge, Bismark and Robi play with Zino. Gideon watches and banters. Luc evangelises or chats. None of these names has been identified as a later crypto associate.

The pickup, motel and poultry trade

The road and hotel belong to the weekday geography. This great-aunt is Mother’s aunt, not the maternal aunt later killed.

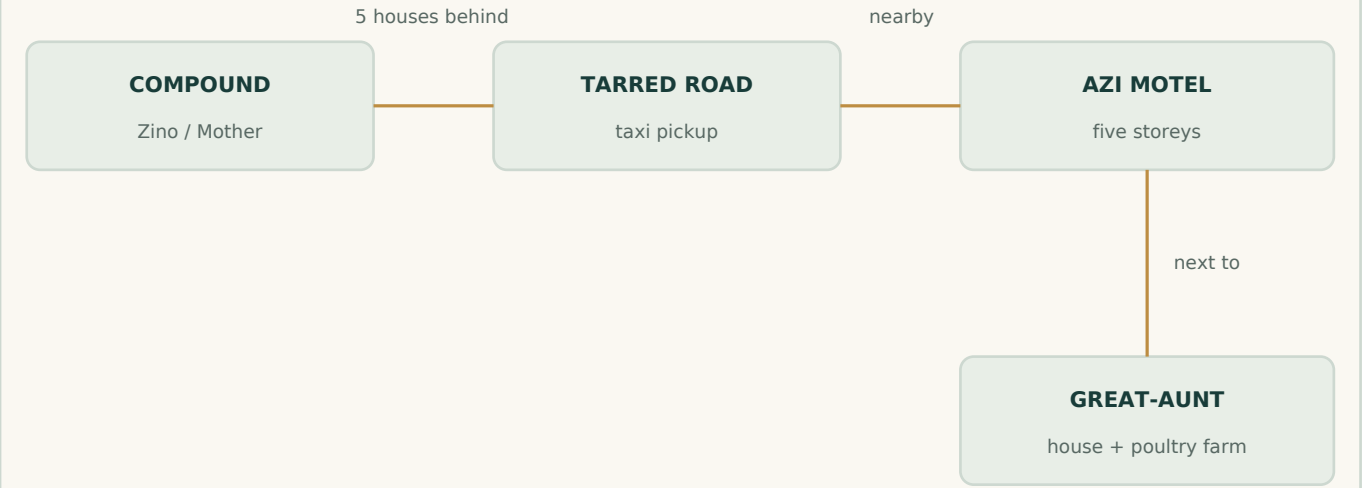


Diagram placement does not assign a compass bearing to “behind” or “nearby”.

School budget: 200 CFA = 100 taxi + 100 at school. A single morning ride costs 100; taxis are taken on three mornings a week. Walking early preserves the full 200 for school spending.

Uniform: light sky-blue short-sleeved shirts for both boys and girls; dark-blue trousers for boys, dark-blue skirts for girls. Boarding uniform remains unconfirmed.

Working ages: Form One about 10–11, Two 11–12, Three 12–13, Four 13–14, Five 14–15. These author-authorized estimates do not establish exact birthdays.

GRAND-CHUKUCHUKU

Fiango — daily life, neighbourhood and character update

Source: Zino's recollections supplied on 30 October 2026.

Authority: This update supersedes conflicting proposed details in the earlier character bible, scripts and concept art.

Key: C = author-supplied recollection; P = proposed dramatic or visual treatment; OPEN = not yet settled. No suggested scene is a claimed transcript.

1. A weekday has its own ticking clock

5:30 a.m. — the cocks behind his room

C: Zino wakes to cock-crowing behind his room around 5:30. Four buckets come before school: two rounds to the well, one full bucket in each hand on each return.

P — screen treatment: Begin with sound in darkness, then a low shot of two bucket handles pulling down on his hands. The first round is not the last. A wide shot establishes the actual route from his detached room to the shared well. This can show fatigue, humour and household duty before anyone explains poverty.

The bathroom queue

C: Tenants share two bathrooms. Zino waits his turn. Feet and lower shins are visible under the short door, telling someone outside that it is occupied.

P — screen treatment: Show only closed doors and feet from the ordinary queue's viewpoint. An impatient toe tapping outside answers still feet inside. No camera enters an occupied cubicle; there is no nudity. Whether this exact door detail applies to bathrooms, toilets or both remains open.

Two rooms, not one

C: Zino has his own room, two apartments detached from his mother's room toward the front. Her room contains a queen-size bed and a drawer beside it. After getting ready for school, he enters her room to check the money left in that drawer.

P — screen treatment: The route between rooms creates private and public space: he must pass other tenants before reaching Mother. Do not invent a locked door, secret drawer, missing cash or theft. Checking the money is his routine, not automatically a suspicious act. Exact room dimensions and the age at which this arrangement began are open.

The 200-CFA decision

C: Usually two coins totalling 200 CFA are left for school. He can use 100 for transport and spend 100 at school. If he gets ready early enough to walk, he can keep the 200 for school. Earlier recollections establish that he sometimes saves lunch money for Nacking Bottle.

Clarified: a single taxi ride costs 100 CFA from the pickup to school, on three mornings per week. It is not three connecting rides. Two coins totalling 200 are confirmed; exact denominations need not be drawn. Exact weekdays and travel time remain open.

P — dramatic engine: Time, effort, hunger and football all draw on the same small budget. A late bathroom queue can change his transport decision. An early start can buy a better school day. That is a real choice; it does not need an invented criminal threat.

2. The TV window and the neighbourhood

C: Beside the compound, a household has a large TV. Zino and other children stand outside a steel-barred window to watch. Later Ayuk's father buys a TV, and Zino watches sport and films inside Ayuk's home, one house from the compound, sometimes until 9 p.m.

Clarified: 'college' means the five secondary day-school years. Ayuk's TV belongs in that period; the exact form/year is still open. Programme titles, TV model, power reliability and the owner's treatment of the children remain unconfirmed.

Relative locations supplied

• **Ayuk:** a house north of Zino's compound; later also described as one house away.

• **Arey:** Ayuk's cousin. A separate house or sleeping arrangement has not been supplied.

• **Noge:** lives next to Ayuk's house; east or west is unspecified.

• **Bismark:** south, next to the TV house.

• **Robi:** next to Bismark; a compass side is unspecified.

• **Original TV house:** adjacent to the compound; do not infer a precise compass side from the other relationships.

• **Taxi pickup / major road:** a tarred road five houses behind the compound. 'Behind' is not yet a compass bearing. Travel time is unconfirmed.

• **Azi Motel:** a nearby five-storey motel. Do not turn the building name into a verified street address.

• **Mother's aunt's home and poultry farm:** next to Azi Motel, supplying poultry directly to it and other hotels. This is Zino's great-aunt, distinct from the maternal aunt later killed. 'Poetry/peotry' is interpreted as poultry from context.

The companion diagram is an adjacency schematic, not a surveyed map. The supplied compound image remains a material/visual reference; it cannot overrule the author's new room, bathroom or neighbour details.

3. The football circle — corrected

C: Zino's street-playing circle includes Ayuk, Arey, Noge, Bismark and Robi. The author describes them as the same age group and class. Luc and Gideon do not play.

Zino

Plays. His ambition, skill, pride and temper can all surface in one ordinary street match. Do not infer that he is always the best player or always wins.

Ayuk

C: A neighbour north of the compound, a class/age peer and a football participant; his father's later TV makes his home part of the group's evening world. **P — design proposal:** an easily read straight-backed silhouette and a cobalt accent distinguish him from Gideon's olive. Hair, body shape, exact clothing and personality await references.

Arey

C: Ayuk's cousin and a football participant in the same circle. **P — design proposal:** a distinct side-part silhouette or rust-coloured sleeve stripe can separate the cousins. Do not make him Ayuk's visual double or invent a rivalry.

Noge

C: Neighbour next to Ayuk, class/age peer, football participant. **P — design proposal:** an open, square stance and one pale-yellow clothing accent. No position, temperament or football skill is yet confirmed.

Bismark

C: Lives south, next to the TV house; a player and peer. **P — design proposal:** a longer shirt silhouette and one maroon accent. His home position does not establish that he owns the TV or polices access.

Robi

C: Lives next to Bismark, a player and peer. **P — design proposal:** a compact, forward-leaning pose and a muted turquoise accent. These are staging ideas, not a real physical description.

Gideon — the sideline voice

C: Does not play. He sits watching and bantering with Zino, particularly when Zino loses. His camera work, business interests, quietness with girls and friendship with Zino remain intact. **Correction:** earlier goalkeeper, scoring teammate and demanding-a-pass scenes are superseded. His humour can puncture Zino's public performance without making their friendship cruel.

Luc — a different use for the same evening

C: Does not play. He spends time evangelising or chatting. His small Bible and Zino's maths help remain part of their friendship. **Correction:** do not automatically make him a referee, scorer or touchline commentator in every match; he may be having an entirely separate conversation nearby.

4. School relationships — keep their timelines distinct

Lizzy

C: Zino's crush in Form One, girlfriend from Form Two, breakup in Form Three. The author corrected his earlier Form Four statement. He recalls her going with an older student who had money.

OPEN: Elianne, previously named first love, is not automatically Lizzy, an alias, or a character to delete. Lizzy's school timeline is now resolved; Elianne's separate place still needs explanation.

P — character treatment: School-age affection, conversation, jealousy and hurt can carry the relationship. Give Lizzy her own perspective. Zino's account of money and the older student is his recollection, not a licence to invent every motive or turn her into a villain.

Mirabel

C: Friendship begins in Form Three because of Zino's brilliance in maths and continues until he leaves for America. **P — character treatment:** a friendship that can outlast classrooms and physical distance. Proposed visual marker: a geometric notebook cover, careful underlining and a distinct hair silhouette once references arrive. Do not infer romance, jealousy or a love triangle.

Sophy

C: Gideon is in love with her from Form Two to Form Five. Zino recalls her as attractive and interested in money; she makes repeated advances toward him, and he turns her down out of loyalty to Gideon.

P — character treatment: Express interest through conversation, chosen company and expectations about spending. Keep her school-age design and camera framing nonsexual. Do not caricature her body or treat her as inherently dishonest. Proposed design marker: a neat, deliberately coordinated school bag or hair accessory, not sexualised clothing.

Tracey

C / OPEN: An older student who attends the night-study space. Zino reports his first sexual experience with her while in Form Three, described as after the Lizzy breakup. Both ages, the precise ordering and the circumstances still need his account.

Treatment: Preserve the disclosure in neutral biographical notes. Do not script or illustrate an explicit sexual scene involving school-age Zino. If later included, use a non-graphic transition and his own description of its emotional meaning. Do not invent adult status, consent, coercion, culpability or a relationship label. No seductive character art is requested or needed for this update.

School uniform and working ages

C: All students wear light sky-blue short-sleeved shirts. Boys wear dark-blue trousers; girls wear dark-blue skirts. Earlier white/cream/brown school palettes are superseded. Distinguish characters through faces, hairstyles, posture, bags and books rather than changing the uniform colour.

P — ages authorized as estimates: Form One about 10–11, Form Two 11–12, Form Three 12–13, Form Four 13–14, Form Five 14–15, using the approximate 2000–2005 day-school chronology and 1990 birth year. Exact birthdays and enrolment dates are not supplied. The author describes similar-age peers; Tracey being older does not establish that she was an adult.

5. Uncle — the suit, faith and cocoa

C: A renowned lawyer known for wearing suits. After giving his life to Christ, he becomes a cocoa businessman. By Zino's Form Three year he opens a large cocoa store in Kumba, with trailers carrying cocoa to Douala. He loved his late brother, Zino's father, deeply. That brother had limited formal education and grew and sold cocoa.

C — reported advice: Uncle tells Zino to study hard so he does not end up like his father. This is the uncle's reported framing, not a narrator's judgement of farming or of the father. His grief, class assumptions and hopes for Zino can coexist.

P — visual correction: The old casual-shirt concept does not establish his lawyer-era wardrobe. Use structured suits for that period. A later store/dispatch look must follow the actual timing and references; do not assume conversion meant poverty, an end to suits, or an instant change in personality.

Story opportunity: Cocoa links the brothers without making their lives identical: one grew it, another traded it at scale. Uncle urging Zino to leave the father's path while building his own future in the same commodity is a complex family tension, not automatically hypocrisy.

OPEN: Did legal work stop or overlap with trading? When did he convert? Why was support intermittent despite his status? What did his America promise mean financially? Do not invent business collapse, withholding, family cruelty or the reason for late fees.

6. How to use this in a thriller series

The extraordinary events need an ordinary world worth losing. Suspense can grow from a specific choice and a visible consequence; every bucket, TV programme and friendship does not need a sinister score.

Proposed three-act short seeds

1. **Four Buckets:** I — the cocks wake him and he wants an early start. II — two full rounds take work. III — the bathroom queue makes him calculate whether walking is still possible. Do not add a real accident without a memory.

2. **The Feet Under the Door:** I — Zino joins the queue. II — neighbours arrive with different schedules. III — his turn changes the morning's time budget. Keep framing outside occupied bathrooms.

3. **Two Coins:** I — the drawer contains 200 CFA. II — transport means spending half; walking costs time. III — choose one and carry that consequence into school.

4. **The Long Walk:** I — he leaves early enough. II — he passes ordinary neighbourhood activity. III — he reaches school with the money intact. Walking is a practical trade, not a magical cure for school fees.

5. **Gideon's Seat:** I — Zino needs a good game. II — Gideon narrates his mistakes from the sideline. III — Zino loses and must decide how to take a joke without turning on a friend.

6. **Two Evenings:** I — football attracts Zino. II — Luc finds someone willing to talk. III — their routes reconnect without either friend needing to imitate the other.

7. **Through the Bars:** I — children gather at the TV window. II — the view is narrow and a match or film matters. III — access becomes part of the pleasure and frustration. No invented ban or malicious owner is required.

8. **Ayuk's TV:** I — during secondary school, the group has a new place to watch. II — the evening grows late. III — 9 p.m. means home and tomorrow's 5:30 start. Exact form/year of purchase remains open.

9. **Mirabel's Sum:** I — a maths question starts a friendship in Form Three. II — mutual respect grows through repeated work. III — give her a response and an independent want; friendship need not become romance.

10. **Bro Code:** I — Gideon hopes Sophy will choose him. II — she approaches Zino instead. III — he refuses without publicly humiliating her or congratulating himself.

11. **The Store:** I — Zino sees his uncle's cocoa operation. II — the uncle urges education while work continues. III — Zino hears the reference to his father and carries a difficult question home. This is proposed staging; no warehouse visit is confirmed.

12. **Form Three:** I — Lizzy's connection with Zino matters. II — attention and money complicate it. III — the breakup happens in Form Three; record the exact sequence before adding Tracey's experience as an aftermath.

7. Corrections to carry into every active draft

• Luc and Gideon watch/socialise beside football; named street peers play. No invented trio team.

• Morning water is four buckets in two trips, one per hand; the new routine is not four separate trips.

• Separate bedrooms are two apartments apart; the illustration is not authority for a shared-bedroom scene.

• 200 CFA is the school allocation, not a fee amount or proof Mother left cash unattended for anyone to take.

• Taxi wording and the TV-era word are resolved by the author: three mornings a week, 100 CFA per ride; TV transition during secondary school. Do not invent the weekday pattern or exact purchase year.

• The new girls remain separate characters. Preserve Elianne until her identity/place is clarified.

• Father's cocoa work is a life and livelihood, not a failure verdict. Uncle's work and faith are now supplied facts, not generic mystery.

• The named childhood players have not been identified as the later crypto circle.

8. Questions awaiting Zino's corrections

1. Elianne's identity/place remains open. Lizzy's breakup is now fixed in Form Three.

2. Taxi frequency/fare is resolved. Exact weekdays and journey length remain open.

3. The TV era is secondary school. What form/year did Ayuk's father get the TV?

4. How old were Zino and Tracey? Record the experience in his own terms before assigning a label or dramatizing an aftermath.

5. From which age/form did Zino have the separate room, and are the feet-visible doors bathroom doors, toilet doors or both?

6. What is the sequence of the uncle's conversion, legal work and cocoa-store operation, and why were school payments sometimes late?